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EDUCATION	Ph.D. in Economics, Stanford University	In progress
	B.S. in Economics, Brigham Young University	2019
	B.S. in Mathematics, Brigham Young University	

REFERENCES	Neale Mahoney (Primary) Trione Director of SIEPR TG Wijaya Prof. of Economics Dept. of Economics, Stanford University nmahoney@stanford.edu	Luigi Pistaferri The Ray Lyman Wilbur Prof. of Economics Dept. of Economics, Stanford University pista@stanford.edu
	Caroline Hoxby Scott & Donya Bommer Prof. in Economics Dept. of Economics, Stanford University choxby@stanford.edu	

RESEARCH FIELDS	Public, Labor
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WORKING PAPERS	The Insurance Value of Federal Rental Assistance Job Market Paper
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Abstract: The US spends \$48 billion on federal rental assistance programs that transfer large in-kind housing subsidies to few low-income households. However, we know little about whether this form of targeting is efficient. In this paper, I reconceptualize federal rental assistance as insurance against joint rent-income risk and quantify its net insurance value. I show that rent prices exacerbate consumption risk beyond income risk alone, and that rental assistance provides targeted insurance by smoothing the share of income households pay as rent. Using Panel Survey of Income Dynamics (PSID) combined with rich HUD administrative data from 2003-2022, I estimate the insurance value use the sufficient statistics approach. The sufficient statistics framework reveals that marginal expansion of rental assistance generates \$1.51 in benefits per dollar of government spending, compared to the literature's estimate of \$0.66. This insurance value primarily derives from insuring income in high-rent locations rather than insuring rent volatility directly, although fixed income households benefit more from rent insurance. Using a structural lifecycle model, I provide new estimates of household preferences for rental assistance and examine the mechanisms behind its insurance value. Counterfactual analysis demonstrates that the program's income-based subsidy design and rationing through waitlists are crucial features that enhance its insurance value relative to alternative designs.

Do Sports Bettors Need Consumer Protection? Evidence from a Field Experiment *with Matthew Brown and Mariana Guido*

Abstract: We conduct a field experiment with high-volume sports bettors to study how biases impact sports betting demand and evaluate corrective policy interventions. We find substantial overoptimism about financial returns: the average participant predicts that they will break even, but loses 7.5 cents for every dollar wagered. We also find evidence of self-control problems, though these are quantitatively smaller. Our estimates imply that surplus-maximizing taxes on sports betting are about twice as large as prevailing taxes. Though targeted interventions can improve efficiency relative to uniform taxes, experimental evidence shows that two specific interventions favored by the gambling industry are ineffective.

Aligning Incentives or Gaming the System? The Impact of Insurer-Physician Acquisitions *with Mariana Guido*

Abstract: In a healthcare market characterized by agency problems stemming from misaligned incentives between insurers and physicians, vertical integration is increasingly seen as a strategy for aligning incentives between insurers and primary care physicians. Using data from the Colorado All Payers' Claims Data, which includes medical encounters from 2015 to 2019, we analyze the effects of a 2017 insurer-physician acquisition in Colorado, across both Medicare Advantage (MA) and Commercial segments. Our findings reveal that the acquisition led to a substantial increase in diagnosis coding by physicians, resulting in an estimated \$1500 increase in risk-adjusted payments per patient per year from the government to the insurer in the MA segment. Furthermore, we note that the acquisition enables physicians to internalize the costs of their referral decisions, leading to an increase in price sensitivity when referring patients to specialists, which translated to average savings of approximately \$300 per inpatient referral for Commercial beneficiaries. Our study shed light on how insurer-physician integration effectively aligns incentives, increasing MA revenues for the insurer while managing the cost of specialist care.

WORK IN
PROGRESS

Misperceptions, Willpower, and the Demand for Talk Therapy *with Sarah Bogl, Matthew Brown, Nick Grasley, and Mariana Guido*

Abstract: Many people with mental health problems do not seek treatment despite evidence that therapy can improve well-being. Working with a provider of gambling addiction therapy, we conduct a field experiment to measure how behavioral biases impact therapy demand and what interventions may overcome them. We consider two behavioral biases: misperceptions and willpower problems. To study misperceptions, we measure how participants' perceptions of therapy change after attending a session. To study willpower issues, we measure participants' willingness to pay for a commitment device to attend therapy. Lastly, we evaluate the effectiveness of two scalable interventions – financial incentives and text message encouragements – at increasing therapy take-up.

Private Equity's Impact on Primary Care and Medicare

with Mariana Guido

Abstract: Private equity (PE) investment in the U.S. healthcare sector has grown exponentially, raising concerns about its impact on the cost and quality of care. This paper investigates how PE acquisitions alter the behavior of primary care practices (PCPs) and, crucially, explores heterogeneity based on the acquirer's structure. We distinguish between acquisitions by pure financial sponsors and those by PE-insurer joint ventures, which may face conflicting incentives between profit maximization and managing population health costs. We construct a novel national dataset by linking PitchBook data on PE acquisitions from 2006 to 2018 with Medicare fee-for-service claims. Then, we employ a staggered difference-in-differences strategy to compare acquired PCPs to not-yet-acquired PCPs. Using state All-Payer Claims Data (APCD), we will further test for differential effects among Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage patients, where insurer-backed owners have stronger incentives to control utilization.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor of Record	2025
	<i>Economic Policy Seminar, Social Insurance & Aging in the U.S.</i>	
	Teaching Assistant, Stanford University, Economics Dept. <i>Advanced Topics in Econometrics, Introduction to Financial Decision Making, Economic Policy Seminar</i>	2021-2025
	Teaching Assistant, Brigham Young University, Economics Dept. <i>Intermediate Macroeconomics</i>	2017
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Stanford University, Department of Economics	2020-2021
	<i>Research Assistant to Prof. Neale Mahoney</i>	
	Brigham Young University, Department of Economics	
	<i>Research Assistant to Prof. Joseph Price</i>	2017-2019
	<i>Research Assistant to Prof. Scott Condie</i>	2018-2019
	Notre Dame University, Department of Economics <i>Research Assistant to Prof. Kasey Buckles</i>	2018
FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS	Bradley Graduate and Post Graduate Fellowship	2025
	NSF Graduate Research Fellowship, <i>honorable mention</i>	2019
	NSF Research Experience for Undergraduates	2018
	Brigham Young University Heritage Scholarship	2012-2019